

Amendment No. 2 to HB0295

Kumar
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 44*

House Bill No. 295

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 71-5-107(a), is amended by adding the following as a new subdivision:

(29) Doula services performed by a person who is listed on the registry created by § 63-1-171. As used in this subdivision (a)(29), "doula services" means a service that provides continuous emotional and physical support throughout labor and birth and intermittently during the prenatal and postpartum periods.

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 63, Chapter 1, Part 1, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

63-1-171.

(a) As used in this section:

(1) "Commissioner" means the commissioner of health;

(2) "Department" means the department of health;

(3) "DONA International" means the nonprofit, international doula certification organization formerly known and originally founded as Doulas of North America; and

(4) "Doula services" means a service that provides continuous emotional and physical support throughout labor and birth and intermittently during the prenatal and postpartum periods.

(b) The commissioner shall post to the department's website a registry of persons who have demonstrated the following by providing proof of completion of a

doula training program recognized by DONA International, or an equivalent certification from another nationally recognized organization with comparable competencies and requirements recognized by the commissioner:

- (1) An understanding of basic anatomy and physiology as related to pregnancy, the childbearing process, breastfeeding, and the postpartum period;
- (2) The capacity to employ different strategies for providing emotional support, education, and resources during the perinatal period;
- (3) Knowledge of and the ability to assist families with utilizing a wide variety of nonclinical labor coping and physical comfort strategies;
- (4) An awareness of strategies to foster effective communication between clients, their families, support services, and healthcare providers; and
- (5) Knowledge of community-based, publicly and federally funded, and clinical resources available to the client for any need outside the doula's scope of practice.

SECTION 3. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.